

Jane Im

Tenure-track faculty member at [CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security](#)

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Research Interests

I am a Human-Computer Interaction and privacy researcher. I design and build systems that address privacy, safety, and consent issues in social media and AI. In particular, I'm interested in developing consentful systems—systems that center people's consent regarding their interactions and data. Consent is fundamentally about ensuring individuals—especially those who tend to be vulnerable—have meaningful agency to decide whether and how an interaction should occur. My work produces theoretical frameworks, deployable system designs, and empirical evidence for building consentful systems.

Education

- Sept. 2018 - **University of Michigan, USA**
Jun. 2025 PH.D. in [Information & Computer Science and Engineering](#)
(completed both programs' requirements via [U-M's Student Initiated Doctoral Program](#))
Thesis: The Critical Role of Consent in Digital Systems
Advisor: Kentaro Toyama
- Mar. 2013 - **Korea University, Republic of Korea**
Jun. 2018 B.B.A. in [Business Administration](#) and B.S. in [Computer Science and Engineering](#)

Professional Experience

- Oct. 2025 - **CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security, Germany**
Tenure-Track Faculty Member
- Jun. 2021 - **Meta, USA**
Aug. 2021 User Experience Research Intern
- May 2020 - **Sassafras Tech Collective, USA**
Aug. 2020 Software Development & Research Intern
- Sept. 2018 - **University of Michigan, USA**
Jun. 2025 Graduate student researcher & Meta Ph.D. research fellow
- Aug. 2016 - **Massachusetts Institute of Technology, USA**
Jun. 2017 Undergraduate student researcher

Awards & Honors

- 2025 University of Michigan's Nominee for ACM Doctoral Dissertation Award
- 2024 Heidelberg Laureate Forum Young Researcher
- 2023 Rising Stars in EECS
- 2023-2025 Meta PhD Research Fellowship
21 fellows were selected out of 3,200 applications. Full coverage of tuition and \$42,000 stipend for two years.
- 2022 Finalist for University of Michigan CSE Graduate Student Honors Competition
Recognizes "top research done by PhD students" at CSE. One of the five finalists. Awarded \$600.

- 2022-2023 Barbour Scholarship
Among the oldest and most prestigious awards granted by the University of Michigan, offering one year of funding to female students from Asia and the Middle East since 1917. Covers stipend of \$36,084 and tuition.
- 2022 Finalist for Meta PhD Research Fellowship
- 2021 ACM CHI Best Paper Honorable Mention Award
- 2020 ACM WebSci Best Paper Runner Up Award
- 2015 SK Telecom Big Data Analytics Competition 3rd Prize
- 2014-2015 Korea University Honor Scholarships (Spring & Fall 2014, Fall 2015)

Grants

- 2022 Unrestricted Gift of \$75,000 from Google, PI: Florian Schaub
Contributed to ideation and grant writing, which led to winning an unrestricted gift of \$75,000 from Google.

Publications

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS AND JOURNAL ARTICLES

- [15] **Jane Im**, Jiyeon Kim, Mamtaj Akter, Tahera Hossain, Kevin Doherty, Pamela J. Wisniewski, Steve Oney, Kentaro Toyama. Human-Computer Interaction PhD Students' and Faculty's Perspectives on Advising. *Under review*.
- [14] **Jane Im**, Kentaro Toyama. Enabling Sensitive Conversations with Consent Boundaries: Moa, a Platform for Discussing PhD Advising Relationships. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2026)*. [pdf]
- [13] Byron Lowens, Sean Scarnecchia, **Jane Im**, Tanisha Afnan, Annie Chen, Yixin Zou, Florian Schaub. Misalignments and Demographic Differences in Expected and Actual Privacy Settings on Facebook. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETs 2025)*. [pdf] [online]
- [12] Lu Xian, Song Mi Lee-Kan, **Jane Im**, Florian Schaub. User-centric Textual Descriptions of Privacy-Enhancing Technologies For Ad Tracking and Analytics. *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETs 2025)*. [pdf] [online]
- [11] Sumit Asthana, **Jane Im**, Zhe Chen, Nikola Banovic. "I know even if you don't tell me": Understanding Users' Privacy Preferences Regarding AI-based Inferences of Sensitive Information for Personalization. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2024)*. [pdf] [acm] (Mentored the lead author.)
- [10] Shubham Atreja, **Jane Im**, Paul Resnick, Libby Hemphill. AppealMod: Inducing Friction to Reduce Moderator Workload of Handling User Appeals. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2024)*. [pdf] [acm]
- [9] **Jane Im**, Ruiyi Wang, Weikun Lyu, Nick Cook, Hana Habib, Lorrie Cranor, Nikola Banovic, Florian Schaub. Less is Not More: Improving Findability and Actionability of Privacy Controls for Online Behavioral Advertising. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2023)*. Coverage: **The Wall Street Journal**; **Invited by FTC to present at PrivacyCon** [pdf] [acm]
- [8] Lia Bozarth, **Jane Im**, Christopher Quarles, Ceren Budak. Wisdom of Two Crowds: Current Practices of Misinformation Moderation on Reddit and How to Improve this Process—A Case Study of COVID-19. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2023)*. [pdf] [acm]
- [7] Paul Resnick, Aljohara Alfayez, **Jane Im**, Eric Gilbert. Searching For or Reviewing Evidence Improves Crowdworkers' Misinformation Judgments and Reduces Partisan Bias. *ACM Collective Intelligence (CI 2023)*. [pdf] [sage]
- [6] **Jane Im**, Sarita Schoenebeck, Marilyn Iriarte, Gabriel Grill, Daricia Wilkinson, Amna Ba-tool, Rahaf Alharbi, Audrey N. Funwie, Tergel Gankhuu, Eric Gilbert, Mustafa Naseem. Women's Perspectives on Harm and Justice after Online Harassment. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2022)*. [pdf] [acm]

- [5] Hariharan Subramonyam, **Jane Im**, Colleen Seifert, Eytan Adar. Solving Separation-of-Concerns Problems in Collaborative Design of Human-AI Systems through Leaky Abstractions. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2022)*. [pdf] [acm]
- [4] **Jane Im**, Jill Dimond, Melody Berton, Una Lee, Katherine Mustelier, Mark Ackerman, Eric Gilbert. Yes: Affirmative Consent as a Theoretical Framework for Understanding and Imagining Social Platforms. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2021)*. **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award** [pdf] [acm] [project website]
- [3] **Jane Im**, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Jackson Sargent, Paige Lighthammer, Taylor Denby, Ankit Bhargava, Libby Hemphill, David Jurgens, Eric Gilbert. Still Out There: Modeling and Identifying Russian Troll Accounts on Twitter. *ACM Conference on Web Science (WebSci 2020)*. **Best Paper Runner Up Award** [pdf] [acm]
- [2] **Jane Im**, Sonali Tandon, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Taylor Denby, Eric Gilbert. Synthesized Social Signals: Computationally-Derived Social Signals from Account Histories. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2020)*. [pdf] [acm]
- [1] **Jane Im**, Amy X. Zhang, Christopher J. Schilling, David Karger. Deliberation and Resolution on Wikipedia: A Case Study of Request for Comments. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2018)*. Coverage: **Motherboard**, **Campus Technology** [pdf] [acm]

SHORT PAPERS

- CTE'17 **Jane Im**, Paul Medlock-Walton, Mike Tissenbaum. App Inventor VR Editor for Computational Thinking. *International Conference on Computational Thinking and STEM Education (CTE 2017) (renamed to CTE-STEM 2017)*. [pdf] [online]

ORGANIZED PANEL PROPOSALS

- CHI'24 Panel **Jane Im**, Himanshu Zade, Steve Oney, Pamela Wisniewski, Kentaro Toyama. Improving Advising Relationships Between PhD Students and Faculty in Human-Computer Interaction. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems 2024*. [pdf] [acm] [project website]
- CSCW'22 Panel Douglas Zytke, **Jane Im**, Jonathan Zong. Consent: A Research and Design Lens for Human-Computer Interaction. *ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing 2022*. [pdf] [acm]

EXTENDED ABSTRACTS AND POSTERS

- CHI'24 LBW **Jane Im**, Kentaro Toyama. Understanding How to Design a Social Computing System That Helps PhD Students Collectively Navigate Mistreatment or Abuse in Advising Relationships. *Extended Abstracts of the ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA 2024)*. [pdf] [acm] [project website]
- SOUPS'23 Poster Annie Chen, Sean Scarnecchia, **Jane Im**, Tanisha Afnan, Byron M. Lowens, Florian Schaub. FB Privacy Helper: A Browser Extension That Simplifies Facebook Ad Privacy Settings. *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security*. Anaheim, CA. August 2023.
- T & S'22 Poster **Jane Im**, Nikola Banovic, Florian Schaub. Designing and Building Social Platforms Grounded in Consent. *Trust & Safety Research Conference*. Stanford, CA. September 2022.

SELECT WORKSHOP PAPERS

- CHI'19 Workshop **Jane Im**. Non-consensual Images & Videos and Consent in Social Media. *Sensitive Research, Practice, and Design in HCI Workshop at ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2019)*.

MEDIA WRITING

- 2021 Heeryung Choi, **Jane Im**, Cindy Lin, Yixin Zou. **An open letter to the U-M community**. *The Michigan Daily*.

Teaching

University of Michigan

- 2020 **SI 539: Web Design, Development, and Accessibility**, Graduate Student Instructor
A graduate course providing hands-on approach to learning responsive, accessible front-end programming for web design. Topics covered include HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, and the POUR design principles of accessible design.
- 2019 **SI 339: Web Design, Development, and Accessibility**, Graduate Student Instructor
An undergraduate version of the course above.

Invited Talks and Panels

- 2025 Information System Security Lab, Korea University
The Critical Role of Consent in Digital Systems
- 2025 DxD Lab, KAIST
The Critical Role of Consent in Digital Systems
- 2024 PrivacyCon, Federal Trade Commission
Less is Not More: Improving Findability and Actionability of Privacy Controls for Online Behavioral Advertising
- 2024 Professor Hyejin Youn's group, Northwestern University Kellogg School of Management
Consent and Consensus on Social Computing Systems
- 2024 Faculty Media Skills: Ask the Experts, University of Michigan School of Information
Invited to talk about my experience interacting with the media as a PhD student (panel discussion).
- 2023 EECS Rising Stars
Affirmative Consent and Power Dynamics as Lenses for Designing Social Computing Systems
- 2023 Cornell Information Science PhD Seminar, Cornell University Information Science
Affirmative Consent and Power Dynamics as Lenses for Designing Social Computing Systems
- 2023 Radical Futures for Social Media, Yale Law School's Social Media Governance Initiative
Interface Designs and Business Models for Safer Social Platforms (panel presentation)
- 2022 GermSyllabus talk series, Germ Network
Affirmative Consent in Platform Design
- 2022 Expertise@Scale Lab, Carnegie Mellon University
Designing and Building Social Platforms Grounded in Consent
- 2021 DUB Shorts Seminar, University of Washington
Yes: Affirmative Consent as a Theoretical Framework for Understanding and Imagining Social Platforms
- 2021 MetaGov Seminar, Metagovernance Project
Reimagining and Building Social Platforms Grounded in Consent
- 2021 HCI Seminar, Seoul National University
Reimagining and Building Social Platforms Grounded in Consent
- 2018 Wikimedia Showcase, Wikimedia Foundation
Deliberation and Resolution on Wikipedia: A Case Study of Requests for Comments
- 2018 IAR Seminar, University of Michigan School of Information
Deliberation and Resolution on Wikipedia: A Case Study of Requests for Comments

Invited Guest Lectures

- 2024 CS5734 Social Computing and Computer-supported Cooperative Work, Virginia Tech
Social Computing Systems Grounded in Affirmative Consent
- 2023 SE 17702 Current Topics in Privacy Seminar, Carnegie Mellon University
Less is Not More: Improving Findability and Actionability of Privacy Controls for Online Behavioral Advertising
- 2020 CS 598 Antisocial Computing Guest Lecture, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Building Social Platforms Grounded in Consent

- 2020 EECS 598 Human-Computer Interaction Guest Presentation, University of Michigan
Synthesized Social Signals: Computationally-Derived Social Signals from Account Histories

Invited Workshop and Consortium Participation

- 2024 Consortium for the Science of Sociotechnical Systems (CSST)
Selected among 21 out of 52 applicants.
- 2023 EECS Rising Stars
Selected among 101 of 288 applicants.
- 2023 Human-Computer Interaction Consortium
Selected as one of the two funded students from University of Michigan to participate.
- 2023 Preparing Future Faculty Seminar
Rackham Graduate School & Center for Research on Learning and Teaching
- 2023 Social Media Governance Initiative Spring 2023 Convening: Beyond Moderation
Yale Law School's Social Media Governance Initiative

Press

[Jane Im's mission to advance affirmative consent in tech](#)
 University of Michigan School of Information News. Abigail McFee. Oct. 15, 2024.

[Heidelberg Laureate Forum Foundation Spotlight – Jane Im](#)
 Heidelberg Laureate Forum Foundation, Sept. 2024.

(Quoted in) [How to Make It Easier for Consumers to Control the Ads They See Online.](#)
 The Wall Street Journal. Suman Bhattacharyya. Sept. 27, 2023.

[2022 CSE Graduate Student Honors Competition highlights outstanding research.](#)
 University of Michigan CSE News. Nov. 10, 2022.

(Quoted in) [Privacy by Design laws will kill your data pipelines.](#)
 Protocol. Hirsh Chitkara. May 16, 2022.

[Predictive Model Identifies Wikipedia Arguments that Will Never Get Resolved.](#)
 Campus Technology. Dian Schaffhauser. Nov. 27, 2018.

[A Third of Wikipedia Discussions Are Stuck in Forever Beefs.](#)
 Vice Motherboard. Samantha Cole. Nov. 7, 2018.

Academic Mentoring

CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security

Jasmeet Kaur (Postdoctoral researcher)
 Rimsha Sarfaraz (Prep-phase PhD student)
 Devika Sreenivasa Rao (Masters student)
 Joys K. Mathew (Masters student)

University of Michigan

Paige Lighthammer, Nuclear Engineering (Undergraduate) [WebSci 20]
 Jackson Sargent, CSE (Undergraduate) [WebSci 20]
 Ankit Bhargava, CSE (Undergraduate) [WebSci 20]
 Taylor Denby, Cognitive Science (Undergraduate) [WebSci 20, CHI 20]
Next: University of Michigan, Master of Science in Information
 Sonali Tandon, School of Information (Masters) [CHI 20]
 Katherine Mustelier, School of Information (Undergraduate) [CHI 21]

Jake Klaristenfeld, CSE (Undergraduate)
 Eleanor Desmond, Electrical Engineering (Undergraduate)
 Jolie Kaplan, CSE (Undergraduate)
 Alice Li Wang, Stephen M. Ross School of Business
 & School of Information (Undergraduate)
 Ruiyi Yang, CSE (Undergraduate) [CHI 23]
Next: Carnegie Mellon University, Master of Science in Intelligent Information Systems
 Weikun Lyu, Math & CS (Undergraduate) [CHI 23]
Awarded the purple Ribbon Certificate for his presentation at the UROP symposium.
Next: Meta, Software engineer
 Nick Cook, Computer Science (Undergraduate) [CHI 23]
 Sean Scarnecchia, CSE (Undergraduate) [SOUPS 23 Poster]
 Annie Chen, CS (Undergraduate) [SOUPS 23 Poster]
 Sumit Asthana, CSE (PhD student) [CHI 24]

Academic Service and Leadership

PROGRAM COMMITTEE

CHI 26, AsiaCCS 2027

REVIEWING

CHI (21 - 25), CSCW (19 - 21, 23 - 24, 26), DIS (26), IMWUT (26), ICWSM (22, 24), UIST (22, 24), FAccT (23), International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (25), IEEE Pervasive Computing (22), PLoS ONE (21), IEE ICDM (19), CHI LBW (20, 24), CSCW Poster (20)
Recognitions for Outstanding Review: UIST 22, CSCW 23-24, CHI 23 (4 times), CHI 24 LBW, CHI 25

OTHER SERVICE TO ACADEMIC COMMUNITIES (SELECTED)

- | | |
|------------------------|---|
| Fall 23 -
Winter 24 | Organizer of Panel on Improving PhD Advising Relationships in HCI
ACM CHI 2024 panel. Co-organized with Kentaro Toyama. |
| Fall 22 -
Spring 23 | UMSI Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee
PhD student representative for UMSI's DEI committee. Contributed to the UMSI's DEI 2.0 Strategic Plan by ensuring PhD students' perspectives are reflected in the proposal, especially regarding PhD advising relationships. |
| Fall 20 -
Winter 21 | Michigan Interactive and Social Computing (MISC)
Co-organized speaker series on HCI and social computing. |
| Fall 20 | UMSI & CSE Student Initiated Doctoral Program (SIDP) Design
Assisted faculty members in drafting a proposal for evaluating students that want to pursue a PhD in both SI and CSE. Was the first PhD student to be formally evaluated by SI and CSE PhD programs and enrolled in the two programs. |
| Fall 19 -
Winter 20 | UMSI Doctoral Executive Committee (DEC)
Co-organized various initiatives for the UMSI PhD student community. |